

D155

Leading with Personal Mastery

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A nurse manager with 15 years of experience and a new master's degree is leading a budget meeting in a crowded conference room. When a colleague questions her staffing numbers, she notices her face getting hot and realizes she tends to get defensive when her numbers are challenged. Which emotional intelligence skill is she showing?

- A. Self-management.
- B. Social awareness.
- C. Relationship management, because the setting is a team meeting.
- D. Self-awareness.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A charge nurse wants to build self-awareness. Which action most directly does that?

- A. Watching staff body language during huddles.
- B. Never showing emotion at work.
- C. Keeping a brief daily log of situations that trigger strong reactions and how she responded.
- D. Taking three breaths before replying to a frustrating email.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A clinical director who recently completed a leadership fellowship gets an angry email from a physician at 10 p.m. accusing her unit of losing lab specimens. The unit has won two safety awards. She feels furious and wants to reply right away. What is the best self-management response?

- A. Reply citing the unit's two safety awards to defend its record.
- B. Reply immediately so the physician knows she is on top of it.
- C. Wait until morning, gather the facts, and respond calmly or talk with the physician directly.
- D. Ignore the email permanently to avoid conflict.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A new nurse leader whose office overlooks the parking garage has three items: a staffing gap for tonight's shift, a draft of next year's retention plan due in two months, and a vendor's request to review a new coffee-machine contract that another manager could handle. Which task should she schedule and protect time for rather than do right now?

- A. The retention plan.
- B. All three should be done immediately.
- C. The staffing gap for tonight.
- D. The coffee-machine contract.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Under the urgent-important matrix, what should a leader do with a task that is urgent but not important to her role?

- A. Delete it.
- B. Delegate it.
- C. Schedule protected time for it.
- D. Do it now herself.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

During a staff meeting in the new break room, a unit manager announces a schedule change. Most staff nod, but two senior nurses who usually speak up sit with arms crossed and say nothing. The manager's own supervisor praised the plan yesterday. What does strong social awareness suggest?

- A. Reprimand the two nurses for negative body language.
- B. Move forward because the supervisor already approved it.
- C. Recognize the silence as possible concern and follow up privately with the two nurses.
- D. Assume the plan is accepted because no one objected.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A new quality team of six nurses from three hospitals meets weekly by video. After a friendly first month, members now argue openly about who owns data collection and whether the project goal is realistic. Their sponsor is a vice president who joined last year. What stage is the team in, and what should the leader do?

- A. Storming; clarify roles and goals and help the team work through the conflict.
- B. Performing; step back and let them work on their own.
- C. Forming; wait for members to get to know each other.
- D. The team has failed and should be restructured.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team has agreed on how it makes decisions and shares work, and members give each other feedback openly, but it still relies on the leader for direction on complex issues. Which stage best fits?

- A. Storming.
- B. Norming.
- C. Adjourning.
- D. Performing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

Several staff tell a peer that their director, who drives in from two towns away, interrupts people in meetings. The director, who was voted leader of the year last spring, has no idea she does this. In the Johari window, where is this behavior, and how should she address it?

- A. No issue, since she was voted leader of the year.
- B. Blind area; ask for and welcome feedback.
- C. Blind area; disclose more personal information.
- D. Hidden area; share more about herself with staff.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A nurse leader knows she is anxious about public speaking but has never told her team. In the Johari window, which area is this, and how is it shrunk?

- A.** Open area; nothing to change.
- B.** Unknown area; reduced by discovery.
- C.** Blind area; reduced by seeking feedback.
- D.** Hidden area; reduced by appropriate self-disclosure.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A night-shift nurse who has worked on the unit for eight years arrived 25 minutes late to three of her last four shifts, and on Tuesday the off-going nurse stayed late and missed her bus. The nurse is well liked and often brings snacks. Which opening line best follows the SBI feedback model?

- A.** “On three of your last four shifts you arrived about 25 minutes late, and on Tuesday the off-going nurse had to stay and missed her bus.”
- B.** “Everyone loves your snacks, but let's talk about the schedule.”
- C.** “You're being unprofessional and don't care about the team.”
- D.** “You're always late.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

An ICU nurse who just bought a house and recently started a running club tells her manager that she has started thinking of patients as “the bed-4 vent” and feels numb when families cry. She still finishes her charting on time. Which burnout dimension does this most clearly reflect?

- A.** Emotional exhaustion.
- B.** Reduced personal accomplishment.
- C.** No burnout, since she still charts on time.
- D.** Depersonalization.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A nurse manager ~~with 15 years of experience and a new master's degree~~ is leading a budget meeting ~~in a crowded conference room~~. When a colleague questions her staffing numbers, she notices her face getting hot and realizes she tends to get defensive when her numbers are challenged. Which emotional intelligence skill is she showing?

Target word: EI domain **Decides:** She is recognizing her emotion and her pattern, not yet acting on it.

A	Adjacent category	Self-management would be what she does next with the feeling.
B	Confusion set	Social awareness is reading others' emotions, not her own.
C	Camouflage	The meeting setting does not decide the domain; the internal recognition does.
D	Correct	Recognizing her own emotion and trigger in the moment is self-awareness.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A charge nurse wants to build self-awareness. Which action most directly does that?

Target word: reverse: pick a behavior for the domain **Decides:** Self-awareness = recognizing own emotions and impact.

A	Confusion set	That builds social awareness.
B	Absolute language	Suppression is not awareness and is not the goal.
C	Correct	Reflection builds recognition of her own emotions and patterns.
D	Adjacent category	That is self-management, regulating a reaction.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A clinical director ~~who recently completed a leadership fellowship~~ gets an angry email from a physician at 10 p.m. accusing her unit of losing lab specimens. ~~The unit has won two safety awards.~~ She feels furious and wants to reply right away. What is the best self-management response?

Target word: regulating a strong reaction **Decides:** Pause, then respond with facts when composed.

A	Camouflage	Past awards do not address the specimen concern.
B	Inverted operation	Acting on the impulse is the opposite of self-regulation.
C	Correct	Pausing and responding deliberately is self-management.
D	Dropped element	Avoidance skips the need to resolve the issue.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A new nurse leader ~~whose office overlooks the parking garage~~ has three items: a staffing gap for tonight's shift, a draft of next year's retention plan due in two months, and a vendor's request to review a new coffee-machine contract that another manager could handle. Which task should she schedule and protect time for rather than do right now?

Target word: which task to schedule **Decides:** Important but not urgent.

A	Correct	Important but not urgent work is scheduled and protected.
B	Absolute language	The matrix exists to separate tasks by urgency and importance.
C	Adjacent category	Urgent and important; it gets done now.
D	Confusion set	Urgent to someone else but not important to her role; it is delegated.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

Under the urgent-important matrix, what should a leader do with a task that is urgent but not important to her role?

Target word: reverse: action from quadrant **Decides:** Urgent, not important = delegate.

A	Confusion set	Elimination is for tasks that are neither urgent nor important.
B	Correct	Urgent but unimportant tasks go to others who can handle them.
C	Adjacent category	Scheduling is for important, non-urgent work.
D	Inverted operation	That is for urgent and important tasks.

6. Answer C Concept 4

During a staff meeting ~~in the new break room~~, a unit manager announces a schedule change. Most staff nod, but two senior nurses who usually speak up sit with arms crossed and say nothing. ~~The manager's own supervisor praised the plan yesterday.~~ What does strong social awareness suggest?

Target word: reading others **Decides:** Unusual silence and closed body language signal unspoken concern.

A	Inverted operation	Punishing the signal discourages honest feedback.
B	Camouflage	Approval upward does not reveal how staff feel.
C	Correct	Reading nonverbal cues and unspoken dynamics is social awareness.
D	Dropped element	Silence is not agreement; it ignores the cues.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A new quality team of six nurses from three hospitals ~~meets weekly by video~~. After a friendly first month, members now argue openly about who owns data collection and whether the project goal is realistic. ~~Their sponsor is a vice president who joined last year.~~ What stage is the team in, and what should the leader do?

Target word: stage and response **Decides:** Open conflict over roles and direction after a polite start.

A	Correct	Conflict over roles and direction is expected in storming.
B	Confusion set	Performing teams have settled roles and little role conflict.
C	Adjacent category	Forming is the polite, uncertain stage they have already passed.
D	Absolute language	Storming is a normal stage, not a sign of failure.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A team has agreed on how it makes decisions and shares work, and members give each other feedback openly, but it still relies on the leader for direction on complex issues. Which stage best fits?

Target word: reverse: stage from behavior **Decides:** Agreed norms, not yet fully autonomous.

A	Inverted operation	Storming is marked by conflict, not agreement.
B	Correct	Shared norms and cohesion without full autonomy is norming.
C	Confusion set	Adjourning is when the team wraps up and disbands.
D	Adjacent category	Performing teams handle complex issues with high autonomy.

9. Answer B Concept 6

Several staff tell a peer that their director, ~~who drives in from two towns away~~, interrupts people in meetings. The director, ~~who was voted leader of the year last spring~~, has no idea she does this. In the Johari window, where is this behavior, and how should she address it?

Target word: quadrant and strategy **Decides:** Known to others, not to self.

A	Camouflage	A past award does not remove the behavior others see.
B	Correct	Feedback from others shrinks the blind area.
C	Inverted operation	Right quadrant, wrong strategy; disclosure shrinks the hidden area.
D	Confusion set	Hidden is known to self, not others, and is reduced by disclosure.

10. Answer D Concept 6 • transfer

A nurse leader knows she is anxious about public speaking but has never told her team. In the Johari window, which area is this, and how is it shrunk?

Target word: reverse: hidden area **Decides:** Known to self, not to others.

A	Dropped element	Others do not know it, so it is not open.
B	Adjacent category	She already knows it, so it is not unknown.
C	Inverted operation	Blind is known to others, not self.
D	Correct	Sharing moves information into the open area.

11. Answer A Concept 7

A night-shift nurse who has worked on the unit for eight years arrived 25 minutes late to three of her last four shifts, and on Tuesday the off-going nurse stayed late and missed her bus. ~~The nurse is well liked and often brings snacks.~~ Which opening line best follows the SBI feedback model?

Target word: feedback wording **Decides:** Specific situation, observable behavior, and impact.

A	Correct	Names the situation, observable behavior, and impact.
B	Camouflage	Leads with an unrelated detail and never names the behavior or impact.
C	Inverted operation	Judges character and intent instead of describing behavior.
D	Absolute language	An absolute that is inaccurate and invites argument.

12. Answer D Concept 8

An ICU nurse ~~who just bought a house and recently started a running club~~ tells her manager that she has started thinking of patients as “the bed-4 vent” and feels numb when families cry. ~~She still finishes her charting on time.~~ Which burnout dimension does this most clearly reflect?

Target word: burnout dimension **Decides:** Detachment from patients and families.

A	Adjacent category	Exhaustion is feeling drained; the key sign here is detachment.
B	Confusion set	That is feeling ineffective; she has not described that.
C	Camouflage	Task completion does not rule out burnout.
D	Correct	Seeing patients as objects and feeling detached is depersonalization.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Self-awareness	Self-awareness is recognizing your own emotions, strengths, limits, and their effect on others as they happen; it is the foundation for the other emotional intelligence domains.	Confusing noticing an emotion (awareness) with controlling it (management).	A leader who notices or names what they are feeling or how they come across.
2	Self-management	Self-management is regulating emotions and impulses, such as pausing before reacting, staying composed under pressure, and adapting to change.	Treating suppression or venting as self-management.	A choice about how to act on a strong feeling.
3	Prioritizing with the urgent-important matrix	Do urgent-and-important work now; schedule important-but-not-urgent work (planning, development) so it is protected; delegate urgent-but-not-important tasks; drop what is neither.	Letting urgent but unimportant interruptions crowd out important, non-urgent work.	A to-do list with deadlines and strategic tasks mixed together.
4	Social awareness	Social awareness is accurately reading others' emotions, needs, and the group's unspoken dynamics (empathy and organizational awareness).	Assuming silence or compliance means agreement.	Cues from others, such as body language, tone, or quiet withdrawal.
5	Stages of team development	Teams move through forming (polite, unclear roles), storming (conflict over roles and direction), norming (agreed ways of working), performing (high autonomy and output), and adjourning.	Reading storming conflict as a sign the team has failed.	A description of how a new team is behaving at a point in time.
6	Johari window	Open = known to self and others; blind = known to others, not self (shrink it by seeking feedback); hidden = known to self, not others (shrink it by disclosure); unknown = known to no one.	Trying to fix a blind spot through self-disclosure.	Something others see about a leader that the leader does not.
7	Behavior-focused feedback (SBI)	Effective feedback names the Situation, the specific observable Behavior, and its Impact, rather than judging character or intent.	Giving labels ("you're unprofessional") instead of observable behavior.	A leader preparing to address a performance issue.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Burnout dimensions	Burnout has three dimensions: emotional exhaustion, depersonalization (cynicism, detachment from patients or colleagues), and reduced sense of personal accomplishment.	Equating burnout with simple tiredness from long hours.	A clinician describing patients as tasks or feeling their work doesn't matter.

Course scope (public description): Leading with Personal Mastery prepares the advanced professional nurse to demonstrate self-awareness, self-management, executive function, and social awareness skills while leading and managing in diverse healthcare settings. In this course, students will learn how to incorporate these skills when developing personal relationships and building teams. Developing both social and emotional intelligence as a nurse leader will ensure that students have the ability develop strong relationships and make wise decisions when interacting with others. Increasing personal mastery will provide students with a set of tools and strategies to improve healthcare by producing high-quality results. Understanding their strengths and weaknesses, as a leader in healthcare will help students create a vision for success that includes making choices that will help balance their work life more effectively.